

Information for new muslims in English...

***** INTRODUCTION TO THIS PAGE

YOU HAVE JUST BECOME A MUSLIM AND WHAT TO DO NEXT

THIS PAGE IS AN EFFORT TO HELP YOU TO LEARN YOUR NEW WAY OF LIFE (ISLAM)

We organized the posts of this page in way that would be beneficial/appropriate for a new Muslim. So, please read the posts according to the order (for clarity of order each post has an article number).***

**For your convenience each post has (1) written materials (on this page or provided links), (2) video (or Audio) links and (3) Mobile phone Apps.

** We suggest you read the written materials first before moving on to video lectures. Some video lectures (links) may not contain all necessary information on a topic.

As Muslims our goal is to follow the GUIDANCE OF ALLAH (subhanahu wa ta'ala) found in:

(1) QURAN and

(2) in Quran's living example (Prophet Mohammad-pbuh) which is recorded in the authentic HADITH collections

--According To The Understanding And Practice Of The "Pious Predecessors (Mainly The Sahaabah And The Two Successive Generations)".

Two important points about our Shariah (Islamic law) we must clearly understand as new Muslims.

******(1) When it comes to strictly "religious matters" (articles of belief and religious rituals/actions) such as the issues we dealt in articles 2 through 10, are governed by the principle of restriction, which means everything is impermissible (forbidden) unless it is proven that it is prescribed in our Shariah (meaning prescribed by Allah). That means no act (or religious belief) of worship may be performed without textual evidence from the Quran and the authentic Hadith collections.

******(2) When it comes to our all others actions (general actions) of daily life, things that we all humans do, such as dressing, eating, working, learning, sleeping, behaving, business dealings, etc., are all permissible unless there is evidence from the Shariah which restricts it. Which means nothing is considered forbidden unless our Shariah forbids it.

The moment a person embraces Islam (takes Shahada) is the greatest moment in his (or her) life. With the declaration of the Shahada (testimony of Faith) he (or she) starts his new life of being a Muslim like a new born baby (as Muslims we believe babies are pure and sinless).

*******Here are few things one should do immediately after taking Shahada.

#(1) Take a bath: <http://newmuslimguide.com/en/your-new-life/70#section-1>

#(2) Sincere Repentance: <http://newmuslimguide.com/en/your-new-life/70#section-2>

#(3) Showing Gratefulness to Allah for His Guidance: <http://newmuslimguide.com/en/your-new-life/70#section-4>

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**###** Our very first request and advice to a new Muslim...Please remove all posts and photos containing indecency, immorality, nudity and vulgar speech. Remember the moment you become Muslim (take your Sahadah), Allah forgives all your past sins and you start your journey like a new born baby (sinless). Obviously this forgiveness is given with the understating that we are ashamed and penitent for the sins of our past out of ignorance.

\* Remember there is no excuse in Islam for showing (and sharing) immorality, pictures dressed in inappropriate clothing and nudity (according to Islam and not according to your past understanding of nudity) of our past, present or future.

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******The information provided in this page are suggestions based on thorough research on our part. We used sources (and scholars) which provide detailed analysis on a particular topic with references from Quran and authentic Hadith.

**If you are not comfortable with certain books, websites or scholars (based on unfamiliarity, previous experience on other topic, preconceived notion or simply informed with wrong information), we humbly request you to make your decision after going through the materials provided here. Feel free to leave those particular opinions/comments that you are not comfortable for more accurate ones.

**Finally, just because we used a scholar (or source) for a certain topic doesn't mean that we take everything from him. If you do not agree with our views on materials provided or do not like any of the scholar we used for a particular topic, we humbly request (please contact us) your kind advice and suggestion for a better option with accurate references.

***** Article # 1

HOW AND WHERE TO FIND THE NEAREST MOSQUE AND MUSLIM COMMUNITY

**The first thing a new Muslim should do is find the nearest mosque or Muslim community. If you know any Muslim who lives in your community or in nearby community is the best way to find the nearest mosque. Otherwise a web search for "Mosque in you city name" or "Masjid in" or "Islamic center of"

**You can also search "Masjid" and "mosque" in Google map of your city. Also if you do not find any mosque in your city search for mosque in your country. And once you locate a mosque you can contact that mosque for more information about a mosque in your city or a city near you.

Following are some websites that will help you find a mosque near you:

**<https://www.halaltrip.com/find-mosques-near-me/>

**<http://www.mosque-finder.com/>

****<https://www.salatomic.com/>**

****<https://www.islamicfinder.org/>**

******* Article # 2**

*****PURPOSE OF LIFE IN ISLAM (AIM OF OUR LIFE)*****

****The most important question in life is " what is the purpose of life?"**

As Muslims the answer is clear and simple. Allah tells us in Quran that He created us to worship Him.

"And I (Allah) did not create the jinn and humankind except to worship Me" (Quran 51:56)

****That is it! The sole purpose of being on this earth is to only worship Allah. There is no ambiguity in this or in anything else in Islam.**

****But how can we be in worship of Allah 24/7 (all the time). We are human, we need to eat, work, sleep and do other things to function. Well, the Islamic understanding of worship, allows all actions of our life to be acts of worship.**

***If we follow the Guidance of Allah and live our life accordingly than even the most enjoyable actions (such as the intimate relation with one's spouse) of our life will be considered as acts of worship and will be rewarded accordingly in the Hereafter. This is perfection, the highest level (in terms of piety) a Muslim can reach or to the very least aim to reach.**

***So, all actions (our daily mundane stuff) of our life have the potential to be acts of worship if those are done (1) sincerely for the sake of Allah (that is to please Him) and (2) according to Allah's Guidance. If a Muslim fulfills the above two conditions in every aspect of his life, he is deemed to be worshipping Allah all the time.**

*For example, when a Muslim sleeps fulfilling the above two conditions, his sleep is considered as an act of worship. When he wakes up and cleans (using bathroom) himself for the preparation of early morning prayer, if he does those fulfilling the two conditions, the entire session is counted as act of worship. Then the actual ritual worship of morning prayer (Fajr Salah) must be done fulfilling the 2 conditions. Then if he goes out to do some morning exercise to keep his body (which is a gift and trust from Allah) healthy and eats his breakfast fulfilling the two conditions, then all these will be considered as acts of worship. In this way a Muslim can always be in the state of worship to Allah.

**By doing the obligatory ritual worships (the daily five prayers, yearly fasting, etc.) and staying away from the major sins, a Muslim fulfills the minimum requirement of his purpose of life.

*In our daily life there are always opportunities in everything we do to be considered as an act of worship, as Allah's messenger Prophet Muhammad (peace be upon him) said:

"...To judge justly between two persons is regarded as Sadaqa (meaning Charity-an act of worship), and to help a man concerning his riding animal by helping him to ride it or by lifting his luggage on to it, is also regarded as Sadaqa, and (saying) a good word is also Sadaqa, and every step taken on one's way to offer the compulsory prayer (Salah in the mosque) is also Sadaqa and to remove a harmful thing from the way is also Sadaqa." (Sahih al-Bukhari 2989)

Why do we worship Allah?

**(1) The primary and number one reason that we worship Allah because he is the only one worthy of being worshiped. Allah is worthy of worship because of Who He is. Even if He did not create us or the heavens, He would still be worthy of worship. Allah is worthy of worship because He is the Most Beautiful, Most Perfect, Most High, Most Majestic, etc (the 99 most beautiful names and attributes of Allah that we know of). When there was nothing He was worthy of Worship and when there will be nothing He would still be worthy of worship. Allah being worthy of worship is independent of who is worshipping Him.

**(2) We worship Allah because He has created us, blessed us with our lives, with our wealth, with our families and with everything else that we have.

**(3) We worship Allah because worship brings Taqwa (righteousness, awareness and fear of Allah). Taqwa brings everything else, such as stability, meaning, values, morality, etc. in our life.

**(4) We worship Allah because in the worship of Allah we will gain His pleasure. And as a reward out of His mercy Allah will grant Jannah (Paradise) to those whom He is pleased with. Allah said in Quran:

"O mankind, worship your Lord (Allah), who created you and those before you, that you may become righteous (al-Muttaqun)" (Quran 2:21)

" Nay! But worship Allah (Alone and none else), and be among the grateful." (Quran 39:66)

" And give good tidings to those who believe and do righteous deeds that they will have gardens [in Paradise] beneath which rivers flow.." (Quran 2:25)

How do we worship Allah?

**We worship Allah according to His guidance and instructions, which are found in Quran and in the Sunnah (the way) of His Prophet (Pbuh). And that means we have to study our religion to have knowledge of Allah's Guidance. And only with proper knowledge and sincerity (only for the sake of Allah) we can perfect our worship.

*There is no room for blindly following and repeating rituals without knowledge and sincerity in Islam. People who have knowledge are the ones who truly fear (are aware/conscious of) Allah. As Allah said in Quran:

"...Only those fear Allah, from among His servants, who have knowledge..." (Quran 35:28)

Finally,

**Allah does not need our worship. Allah does not get any more Majestic or any more Greater through our worship. Our worship do not quench Allah's thirst or hunger or anything else we may think of. What it does is, it pleases Allah to see that we are in total submission to Him, even when we are given the choice and free-will to disbelieve and disobey Him.

**This life is a test for us from Allah to see if we are able to fulfill the purpose we were created for. To submit to Him alone and follow His Guidance to the best of our ability with proper knowledge and sincerity. Allah should be worshiped at all times, in times of hardship and in times of ease and only through this we can be successful in this life and Hereafter. Allah said in Quran:

" Who (Allah) has created death and life, that He may test you which of you is best in deed. And He is the All-Mighty, the Oft-Forgiving;" (Quran 67:2)

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MUST WATCH VIDEO:

The Aim of Our Life by Dr. Yasir Qadhi:

<https://youtu.be/8YXeI38RoQU>

***** Article # 3

OUR FAITH (DETAIL DESCRIPTION OF THE 6 ARTICLES OF FAITH/BELIEF IN ISLAM)

The 6 articles of Faith summarizes the core beliefs of Islam. These are also known as " Arkan al-Imaan" or " Creed of Islam" or Fundamental beliefs of Islam. Having firm belief on all 6 articles is a must for every Muslim. Proper knowledge and understanding of these articles build a strong foundation of Islam in each one of us as a Muslim. An individual who doubts any of these articles cannot be considered a Muslim.

DETAILED DISCUSSION with EVIDENCES

**Review of meaning of our testimony of Faith: <http://newmuslimguide.com/en/your-faith/73>

**(1) Introduction and Belief in Allah.

*Part-1: <http://newmuslimguide.com/en/your-faith/133>.

*Part-2: <http://newmuslimguide.com/en/your-faith/134#section-1>

**(2)Belief in the Angels:

<http://newmuslimguide.com/en/your-faith/134#section-2>

**(3) Belief in the Divine Books:

<http://newmuslimguide.com/en/your-faith/134#section-3>

**(4) Belief in the Messengers:

<http://newmuslimguide.com/en/your-faith/141>

**** (5) Belief in the Last Day:**

<http://newmuslimguide.com/en/your-faith/357>

**** (6) Belief in the Divine Decree:**

<http://newmuslimguide.com/en/your-faith/356>

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**\*\*\*VIDEO LINKS\*\*\***

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**\*\* Importance & Blessings of Knowledge - Fundamentals of Faith - Yasir Qadhi:**

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2sLg4UARh3g>

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**## Belief in Allah videos: Please watch the videos in order to gain the proper understanding.**

**\*1\* Belief in Allah [Tawheed] - Fundamentals of Faith - Yasir Qadhi:**

[https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=5TR6\\_ChJipA](https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=5TR6_ChJipA)

**\*2\* Blessings and Importance of Tawheed - Fundamentals of Faith - Yasir Qadhi:**

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ExDxLNeaC14>

**\*3\* Tawheed of Lordship (Rububiyya)- Fundamentals of Faith - Yasir Qadhi:**

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ttfy6EKtA4>

**\*4\* Proofs of Existence of God - Fundamentals of Faith - Yasir Qadhi:**

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Pz1lrqgDhjl>

**\*5\* Tawheed of Lordship not Enough - Fundamentals of Faith - Yasir Qadhi:**

[https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=P1rbK2i30\\_k](https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=P1rbK2i30_k)

**\*6\* The importance of the concept: Tawheed-ul Uloohiyah - Fundamentals of Faith - Yasir Qadhi:**

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=L5mNKa63w3s>

**\*7\* The Conditions of La Ilaha illAllah - Fundamentals of Faith - Yasir Qadhi:**

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=tAkWjOa7xpE>



\*8\* What is the meaning of worship - Fundamentals of Faith - Yasir Qadhi:

[https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=\\_sDdin\\_o-bl](https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=_sDdin_o-bl)

\*9\* Tawheed of Allah's Names and Attributes (Part 1) - Fundamentals of Faith - Yasir Qadhi:

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=QRrNkZixwV0>

\*10\* Tawheed of Allah's Names and Attributes (Part 2) - Fundamentals of Faith - Yasir Qadhi:

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=65dXpQ4klGY>

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\*\*Belief in the Angels of Allah:

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=qMZQa-uGlzI>

\*\* Belief in the Books - Dr. Bilal Philips:

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=JdvCcNCTTVE>

\*\* Belief in the Messengers:

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=6wEbU9I4PL0>

\*\* Day of Judgement - Lecture by Saed Rageah:

[https://www.youtube.com/watch?time\\_continue=1&v=GjoUSsnev-k](https://www.youtube.com/watch?time_continue=1&v=GjoUSsnev-k)

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\*\* Belief in Qadar:

\* the meaning of belief in al qadr? By dr zakir naik: [https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=y03wiAPX\\_es](https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=y03wiAPX_es)

\* Qadr / Predestination / Free-will / Divine Decree - Nouman Ali Khan:

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2Ar4cu5znTI>

\* If God knows everything, Why is it my Fault? - Nouman Ali Khan:

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Am9IxyQVCL8>

## \*\*\*\*\* Article # 4

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\*\*\*QURAN\*\*\* (THE PRIMARY SOURCE OF ISLAMIC INFORMATION)\*\*\*

\*The Quran is the Last and Final Revelation from Allah.

\*The Quran is a complete guide covering all aspects of our life.

\*The Quran is the inimitable and unique Arabic Speech or Word of Allah revealed orally to Prophet Mohammad (pbuh) by angel Gabriel in wording and meaning, which has been preserved in memory (by memorization) and in writing and reached us by numerous authentic continuous (mutawatir) transmissions.

### \*\*BRIEF HISTORY\*\*

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\* The entire Quran was revealed to prophet Muhammad (pbuh) gradually over 23 years. This revelation began in one night known as the Night of Decree (Laylat Al-Qadr) in the month of Ramadan (9th month of Islamic calendar) when Prophet Muhammad was about 40 years old and ended with his death at age sixty three.

\* During the Prophet's (pbuh) lifetime the entire Quran was memorized by many companions, written down in different materials and kept in secured possession of the Prophet and other prominent companions.

\* Immediately after the Prophet's (pbuh) death (632/633 CE) Abu Baker (leader of the believers) gathered all of the main scribes, Huffaz (memorizer of Quran), all written materials of the Quran, and had it written down on parchment and made a single volume which was correct, authentic and complete.

\* During Uthman's Caliphate, Uthman in consultation with other prominent companions of the Prophet decided to make several official copies from the single volume using the same methodology that was used by Abu Baker. Uthman then sent these official copies along with an expert companion to each Muslim province and ordered to destroy all other unofficial, partial and personal Quranic materials.

\* Quran we use today in all over the world are made from those copies. Unlike other scriptures that were changed with human interpolations and omissions, the Quran has remained unchanged and will remain so as Allah Himself has guaranteed its preservation and protection.

**\*\* The Quran is only available in Arabic, its original language. The Quran's beauty, style, miraculous nature and its message can only be understood in full extent by understanding Arabic. But for the benefit of the non-Arabs the meaning of the Quran has been translated in many languages.\*\***

**\*\*SOME IMPORTANT FACTS ABOUT THE QURAN\*\***

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\* The Quran has 114 chapters (Surahs) which have more than 6000 verses. Surahs within Quran are not organized in the chronological sequence of their revelation. In some cases verses within a surah are not organized in the chronological order of their revelation. The order of the verses within a surah and the order of the surahs within the Quran were revealed from Allah.

\* The word Quran means reading or recitation indicating the fact that the Quran is to be both recited from memory and read from text. All Muslims have to memorize some parts of the Quran and there are many who have memorized the entire Quran.

\* The Quran's fundamental message is to submit to Allah and worship Him alone. As a complete guide, it covers all aspects of life. Examples of some topics in the Quran include the following but are not limited to: defining the creed; expounding moral instruction; admonishing believers and non-believers; inviting people to explore, question and validate the truth it proclaims; giving good news of afterlife; laying down laws from dealing with mundane matters of daily lives to matters of warfare; drawing lessons from historical events etc.

\* Verses (and Surahs) revealed before Prophet Muhammad's (pbuh) migration known as Hijra to Madina are known as Makki, and those revealed after migration (Hijra) to Madina are known as Madani (with few exceptions).

\* The Quran is a unique book. Its theme, style, order, and arrangement of information is unlike any other book. Readers are likely to notice that diverse kinds of materials exist side by side. It may seem confusing to a new reader as it will navigate through different topics and at times may seem to change from one topic to another without any notice or indication.

\* The Quran does not relate history in a conventional sense. The Quran narrates many narratives in brief and at times in details including stories of previous Prophets. Whenever the Quran brings up a snapshot of history, it is for a reason. That reason may be correcting what was related in other religious books, or to teach a lesson, or show an example.

\* The Quran is not a book of science but it relates signs for the curious and hungry mind to contemplate. One may find many signs indicating well established scientific facts like embryology, origin of universe, earth's shape, earth and sun's rotation, expansion of the universe, every living being made of water and many others. No established scientific fact is ever in disagreement with the signs related in the Quran.

\* In the Quran, God at times refers to Himself in 1st person, third person (he) and at times 1st person plural (we or us). In Arabic, it is as correct to use the plural when speaking of one person as it is to use the singular. But the plural is used for respect and glorification, and no one is more deserving of respect

and glorification than God. So the singular is used to affirm the fact that He is One and has no partner or associate, and the plural is used to affirm His glory and majesty, may He be exalted.

\* The Quran at times gives details about a topic and at times gives little details about a topic. At times, the background and circumstances under which particular verses containing orders or rules were revealed have not been mentioned. But keep in mind God didn't just send His final revelation but He sent along with it the final Messenger Prophet Muhammad, who had lived according to that complete guidance and gave us the details of the complete guidance by practice and instruction.

\*\*\* Now that we know a little about the Quran let us start to read the Quran. As new Muslims we may start with a translation of the meaning of the Quran. We can do that from one of the following options listed below. As Muslims we must also learn a limited amount of Arabic which will enable us to at least read/recite the Quran (as it is essential for our daily Prayer). Please listen to lectures from scholars on discussion of the verses/surahs of the Quran.

\* "Tafseer of the Quran" gives a detailed explanation, interpretation, or commentary for clear understanding of the verses of the Quran.

#### WHERE TO GET A COPY OF THE QURAN

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\*\*Please visit a mosque near you to get a Quran.

\*\*Online:

\* <https://quran.com>

\* <http://tanzil.net>

\* <http://legacy.quran.com>

\*<http://www.recitequran.com>

\*\*\*You can also request a free copy from this website:

\*<http://cpsglobal.org/content/order-free-quran>

\*<http://sendaquran.com/>

\*<http://www.allahsquran.com/free/>

\*<https://www.freequraan.org.uk/order-free-qur-aan.html>

### \*\*\*Mobile Apps:

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(1) QURAN FOR ANDROID:

<https://play.google.com/store/apps/details?id=com.quran.labs.androidquran>

(2) IQURAN LITE: <https://play.google.com/store/apps/details?id=com.guidedways.iQuran>

(3) Al-Quran (Free): <https://play.google.com/store/apps/details?id=com.isysway.free.alquran>

***Why and how to learn Arabic of the Quran:

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(1) Why and How to Learn Arabic of the Quran - Nouman Ali Khan:

[https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=yfflgF\\_H0kY](https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=yfflgF_H0kY)

(2) The Quran Explained - Nouman Ali Khan:

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=gW8zG2a8rDM>

(3) Nouman Ali Khan - Brilliance of The Book:

[https://www.youtube.com/watch?time\\_continue=41&v=dWLuFbl\\_pVg](https://www.youtube.com/watch?time_continue=41&v=dWLuFbl_pVg)

(4) Divine Speech Prologue - Part 1 - Nouman Ali Khan:

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=BaS5NsvZ4yM>

(5) Divine Speech Prologue - Part 2 - Nouman Ali Khan:

[https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=aWUy\\_luMq0Q](https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=aWUy_luMq0Q)

### \*\*\*Learn to read Quran in Arabic:

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** How To Read Quran By Nouman Ali Khan: There are 17 videos which will enable you to be able to read/recite Quran:

Part 1: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=1aJNYfh_OX8

**Learn the Easy Way To Understand Quran And Salah:

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SHNMiOZaywg>

***Good lectures explaining the surahs of the Quran:

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Surah Al-Fatiha with Nouman Ali Khan:

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=IGgkzDFqOUY>

Surah Al-Asr with Nouman Ali Khan:

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=IGgkzDFqOUY>

Surah Al-Ikhlâs - Nouman Ali Khan:

[https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Q2\\_AbXfd28A&index=49&list=PL25AD5F33DE986868](https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Q2_AbXfd28A&index=49&list=PL25AD5F33DE986868)

## \*\*\*\*\* Article # 5

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\*\*\*HADITH (THE SECONDARY SOURCE OF ISLAMIC INFORMATION)\*\*\*

\*\* Hadith (or Sunnah) is the collection of commands, sayings, actions, expressed approvals/disapprovals and implicit approvals of Prophet Muhammad. It explains many aspects of the Quran and help us understand it. Hadith were also memorized and recorded meticulously by the Prophet's companions and passed on to successive generations. There are eight widely used Hadith Collections and of them Six are most famous.

\*\*Every one of us should have some basic knowledge of hadith, the famous collections and classification (based on authenticity) of hadith . Familiarize yourself with the hadith collections of Imam Bukhari and Muslim.

\*\*(1) Sahih Al-Bukhari: Generally regarded as the single most authentic collection of hadith. Sahih Al-Bukhari covers topics from almost all aspects of life in providing proper guidance from the messenger of Allah. In Imam Bukhari's 'Al-Jami-al-Sahih' (Sahih Al Bukhari) the Imam (born within 180 years of Prophet's death) had recorded all the hadiths of the Prophet which he found to be genuine after thorough examination and scrutiny. He spent sixteen years in research and examined more than sixty thousand hadiths from which he selected only hadiths whose genuineness and accuracy is established beyond the slightest doubt. Deducting duplicates, the Imam's collection contain about four thousand distinct hadiths.

\*Access online from <https://www.sunnah.com/bukhari>.

**\*\* (2) Sahih Muslim:** Sahih Muslim is the most authentic book of Hadith after Sahih Al-Bukhari and contains about 7,500 hadiths. Imam Muslim (born within 190 years of Prophet's death) is one of the foremost preservers of hadith of the Prophet. His book comes second only to Sahih al Bukhari in terms of authenticity according to majority of scholars.

\*Access online from [www.sunnah.com](http://www.sunnah.com).

**\*\*The other four prominent Hadith collections are:**

These four collections contains mostly authentic but also some weak (doubtful or deficient in proof of authenticity) hadiths. Therefore these must be approached with careful consideration. In some of the recent versions of these collections, hadiths are marked with the grade of authenticity for our benefit. The two other widely used ones are "Muwatta Imam Malik" and "Musnad Ahmad ibn Hanbal".

**\* (3) Sunan Abu Dawood:** <https://www.sunnah.com/abudawud>

**\* (4) Jami At-Tirmidhi:** <https://www.sunnah.com/tirmidhi>

**\* (5) Sunan An-Nasa'i:** <https://www.sunnah.com/nasai>

**\* (6) Sunan Ibn Majah:** <https://www.sunnah.com/ibnmajah>

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**** Must watch Videos On Hadith:**

(1) Usool ul Hadith Part 1/3 - Yasir Qadhi:

https://www.youtube.com/watch?time_continue=1&v=bX33vuY-lo8

(2) Usool ul Hadith Part 2/3 - Yasir Qadhi:

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=XoGvQ5eXO2s>

(3) Usool ul Hadith Part 3/3 - Yasir Qadhi:

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=7YfDdA2_HPo

(4) Sciences of Hadith Part 1/2- Yasir Qadhi

https://www.youtube.com/watch?time_continue=6&v=KRP0QeyKIYU

(5) Sciences of Hadith Part 2/2- Yasir Qadhi

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Q-_RSi0B7g4

***** Article # 6

REQUIRED PHYSICAL CLEANLINESS/PURIFICATION (TAHARA)

**Allah requires all human beings to stay physically and spiritually pure/clean. Becoming a Muslim is the first step towards the spiritual Purification.

*And on the physical side, Allah requires Muslims to clean their bodies, clothes, houses and community.

*While people generally consider cleanliness desirable, Islam makes it a requirement for us to follow certain rules of cleanliness to perform certain ritual worships and to stay in good health.

DETAILED DISCUSSION with EVIDENCES

**The Meaning of Purification (Tahaarah):

<http://newmuslimguide.com/en/your-purification/57#section-1>

**Purification from Physical Impurity:

<http://newmuslimguide.com/en/your-purification/57#section-2>

** Toilet Etiquette:

<http://newmuslimguide.com/en/your-purification/57#section-3>

**Ritual Impurity (Hadath):

<http://newmuslimguide.com/en/your-purification/57#section-4>

**How to Perform Wudoo?:

<http://newmuslimguide.com/en/your-purification/58>

**The Major Ritual Impurity and the Full Ablution (Ghusl /Ritual Bath):

<http://newmuslimguide.com/en/your-purification/59#section-1>

**How to Remove the Major Ritual Impurity (Janaabah)?: <http://newmuslimguide.com/en/your-purification/59#section-2>

VIDEO LINKS

**Short introduction to Fiqh and basic fiqh of Purification part-1 by Yasir Qadhi;
<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=F73FHnMNsW4>

** Fiqh of Purification part-2 by Yasir Qadhi:
<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nYInm734R1I>

**How to perform Wudoo (wudu):
<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=5KweAf1Z8sY>

**How To Do Ghusl : Ritual Bath In Islam:
<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=PEgUbg9YuCA>

**For Sisters only - Do's and Don'ts For Menstruating women:
<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=bz1DUfcK7ko>

***** Article # 7

REQUIRED DAILY PRAYER (SALAH)

**The Prayer (known as "Salah" in Arabic or Namaz in some other languages) is the most important and greatest act of worship in Islam.

* By the order of Allah a Muslim is required to offer Prayer (Salah) five times a day.

* The five daily Prayers must be offered at specified time which are at dawn, noon, mid-afternoon, sunset and nightfall.

* Allah commands us to observe the required five daily prayers (Salah) under all circumstances, even when we are sick or travelling.

* Prayer (Salah) establishes a direct personal and spiritual connection between us and Allah, and is a constant and practical reminder of a Muslim's duty to surrender to Allah.

* The Prayers (Salah) develop in a Muslim the qualities of self-discipline, steadfastness and obedience to God, leading one to be patient, honest and truthful in the affairs of his/her life.

DETAILED DISCUSSION with EVIDENCES

The Prayer:

<http://newmuslimguide.com/en/your-prayer/142#section-1>

**What Are the Conditions that Must Be Met before Engaging in Prayer?:

<http://newmuslimguide.com/en/your-prayer/142#section-2>

** The Five Obligatory Prayers and Their Times: <http://newmuslimguide.com/en/your-prayer/142#section-3>

**The Place of Prayer: <http://newmuslimguide.com/en/your-prayer/142#section-4>

Performing the Prayer:

<http://newmuslimguide.com/en/your-prayer/143#section-1>

**Soorat Al-Faatihah Explained:

<http://newmuslimguide.com/en/your-prayer/143#section-2>

** How to Pray (The Standing, Bowing and Prostrate Postures): <http://newmuslimguide.com/en/your-prayer/147>

** The Pillars and the Obligatory Acts of the Prayer: <http://newmuslimguide.com/en/your-prayer/144#section-1>

Acts which Invalidate the Prayer:

<http://newmuslimguide.com/en/your-prayer/144#section-2>

** The Recommended Voluntary Prayers:

<http://newmuslimguide.com/en/your-prayer/144#section-3>

** The Congregational Prayer:

<http://newmuslimguide.com/en/your-prayer/144#section-4>

** The Call to Prayer (Adhaan):

<http://newmuslimguide.com/en/your-prayer/144#section-5>

** Humility and Attentiveness in Prayer:

<http://newmuslimguide.com/en/your-prayer/146#section-1>

**** The Friday Prayer (Salaat-ul-Jumu'ah):**

<http://newmuslimguide.com/en/your-prayer/146#section-2>

**** The Traveller's Prayer:**

<http://newmuslimguide.com/en/your-prayer/146#section-3>

**** The Prayer of the Sick:**

<http://newmuslimguide.com/en/your-prayer/146#section-4>

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**\*\*\*VIDEO LINKS\*\*\***

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**\*\*Basic Fiqh - Yasir Qadhi - Salah part 1:**

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=cPRW3SrhCuA>

**\*\* Basic Fiqh - Yasir Qadhi - Salah part 2:**

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=9aIWH3aKCPC>

**\*\* How to Pray 2 RAKAT PRAYER - Detailed Guide:**

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=DLWJtXtmnbM>

**\*\* How to Pray 3 RAKAT PRAYER - Detailed Guide.**

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=sv1fpmjmsac>

**\*\* How to Pray 4 RAKAT PRAYER - Detailed Guide.:**

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=TDit-zlSp7g>

**\*\*\*\*\* Article # 8**

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### \*\*\*REQUIRED ANNUAL FASTING (SAWM)\*\*\*

\*\*Fasting (known as "Sawm" in Arabic) is an important act of worship in Islam.

\* By the order of Allah every Muslim (who reached puberty) is required to Fast the entire month of Ramadan.

\* Ramadan is the ninth month of Islamic lunar calendar, which is either 29 or 30 days (depending on moon cycle).

\*Muslims fast from dawn until sunset, abstaining from food, drink and sexual relations with spouse.

\*Fasting is prescribed for us to attain "Taqwa"( loosely translated as 'God consciousness' or 'God-fearing' or 'piety')

\*Fasting serves as a mode of spiritual purification; nurtures patience and self-restraint; and keeps us away from selfishness, greed, extravagance and other immorality.

### \*\*\*DETAILED DISCUSSION with EVIDENCES\*\*\*

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\*\* Fasting and Ramadan:

<http://newmuslimguide.com/en/your-fast/60#section-1>

\*\* The Wisdom behind Fasting:

<http://newmuslimguide.com/en/your-fast/60#section-2>

\*\* Virtues of Fasting:

<http://newmuslimguide.com/en/your-fast/60#section-3>

\*\* Things which Break the Fast:

<http://newmuslimguide.com/en/your-fast/60#section-4>

\*\* Those Who Are Exempt from Fasting:

<http://newmuslimguide.com/en/your-fast/60#section-5>

\*\* The Festival of Fast Breaking ('Eed-ul-Fitr): <http://newmuslimguide.com/en/your-fast/60#section-6>

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VIDEO LINKS

**Yasir Qadhi - Fiqh of Fasting: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=9gOd0U_hjD0

***** Article # 9

REQUIRED YEARLY CHARITY (ZAKAH):

** "Obligatory Charity" (known as "Zakah / Zakat" in Arabic) is an important act of worship in Islam.

*The word Zakah means 'to cleanse' or 'to purify'. And Islamically the act of giving zakah purifies an individual's wealth and himself.

*Zakah is an obligatory charity due on wealth, above certain levels, and to be distributed to specific groups of people at specific time.

*Zakah is a pillar of Islam and it is very important as it is mentioned and linked to Salah in more than 80 places in Quran.

* Zakah is to be calculated once(same time) a year after a muslim become owner of the excess wealth for one year.

*A Muslim who doesn't have excess wealth beyond the prescribed amount does not have to pay Zakah.

*Example of excess wealth which are part of Zakah calculation, includes (1)gold, (2)silver,(3) money, (4)some agricultural produce, (5)business inventory and (6)some livestock, etc.

*In most cases Zakah is 2.5% of the excess wealth.

*Zakah is given primarily to poor and needy Muslims. Zakah money can be spent on disaster relief, free slaves and captives of war. Zakah money can also be spent on certain debt relief; traveler in need; and struggling and striving in the cause of Allah.

*Zakah cannot be given as donations to mosques (masjids) or religious institutions.

*By giving Zakah not only we purify our wealth but also help in the process of building a good society. Zakah ensures flow of wealth from rich to poor. It reduces the gap between the rich and the poor and ensures an equitable society where everyone has a right to contribute and share.

* There will be severe punishment for those how do not pay Zakah which is mentioned in many places in Quran and Hadith.

DETAILED DISCUSSION with EVIDENCES

** The Ultimate Objectives of Zakaat :

<http://newmuslimguide.com/en/your-zakaat/61#section-1>

**Types of Wealth upon which Zakaat Is Due:

<http://newmuslimguide.com/en/your-zakaat/61#section-2>

**Recipients of Zakaat:

<http://newmuslimguide.com/en/your-zakaat/61#section-3>

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### \*\*VIDEO LINKS\*\*

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\*\*Yasir Qadhi - Fiqh of Zakah: [https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=o0i\\_QCsJBuA](https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=o0i_QCsJBuA)

## \*\*\*\*\* Article # 10

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### \*\*\*HAJJ-THE REQUIRED PILGRIMAGE\*\*\*

\*\* Hajj, the annual Muslim pilgrimage to Makkah, is the fifth pillar of Islam.

\*Hajj is a religious journey which takes place in the city of Makkah in Saudi Arabia, which starts on 8th day of 12th month (Called Dhu al-Hijjah) of Islamic calendar and last for 5 to 6 days.

\* By the order of Allah every muslim (when physically and financially able) must perform Hajj at least once in a lifetime.

\* Muslims who are not physically (not able to perform many of the religious performance of Hajj) or financially (do not have enough money to take upon the journey and necessary expenses) are

excused from this obligation. But the very moment the two conditions are met, one must make every effort to do Hajj.

\*\*\*DETAILED DISCUSSION with EVIDENCES\*\*\*

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\*\*The Importance and Virtues of Makkah and the Sacred Mosque:  
<http://newmuslimguide.com/en/your-pilgrimage/67#section-1>

\*\*The Meaning of Hajj:  
<http://newmuslimguide.com/en/your-pilgrimage/67#section-2>

\*\*The Ability to Perform Hajj: Different Circumstances: <http://newmuslimguide.com/en/your-pilgrimage/67#section-3>

\*\*Virtues of Hajj:  
<http://newmuslimguide.com/en/your-pilgrimage/67#section-4>

\*\*The Ultimate Goals of Hajj:  
<http://newmuslimguide.com/en/your-pilgrimage/67#section-5>

\*\*The Festival of Sacrifice ('Eed-ul-Adhaa):  
<http://newmuslimguide.com/en/your-pilgrimage/68#section-1>

\*\*Visiting Madeenah:  
<http://newmuslimguide.com/en/your-pilgrimage/68#section-2>

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VIDEO LINKS

**HAJJ (HD) || Full Documentary || A Lifetime Experience:
<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ir8yS8t6yhM>

***** Article # 11

RULES OF DRESS/CLOTHING (DRESS CODE)

Islam is a complete way of life, hence Guidance of Allah also contains general (or specific on certain things) directions for each and every aspect of our life. And from that perspective our Shariah (Islamic law) gave us general directions on how to dress modestly and while prohibits certain things.

Brief description of general guidelines and some prohibitions

*Both men and women are expected to dress in a way which is modest and dignified.

*No particular types or styles of dress is recommended.

*Men must cover their body modestly and the minimum amount to be covered is between the navel and the knee. Women must cover their entire body except the face and hands when in public or in the presence of 'non-Mahram' men.

*Clothing should be loose fitting to the point that it may not reveal the shape of the body (which is required to be covered).

*Dressing (or clothing) imitating opposite gender (men dressing like women or vice versa) is not allowed.

*Dressing (or clothing) imitating religious personality (such as Roman Catholic priest or monks) of other religion or using religious symbols (such as cross) of other religion is not allowed.

*Clothing made of silk and dressing with gold is not allowed for men.

Mahram is a person, man or woman related to a particular individual by blood, marriage or breastfeeding. Mahram is a person, we are not permitted to marry and do not have to observe strict dress restrictions.

*Mahram due to close blood relationship: For a woman, her father, grandfather, son, grandson, brother, both paternal and maternal uncles and nephews. Likewise for a man, his mother, daughter, granddaughter, sister, both paternal and maternal aunties and nieces.

* Mahram due to Breastfeeding: This includes anyone, man or woman breastfed by the same mother or wet nurse. Also includes the brother or husband of the wet nurse.

* Mahram due to Marriage: People who become our relatives by marriage, such as father-in-law, mother-in-law, stepfather, stepmother, stepson, stepdaughter.

Awrah is the parts of the body that should be kept covered. A man's Awrah is from navel to knee and a women's Awrah is her entire body except face and hands.

* There is no Awrah between a husband and wife.

* When a woman is amongst women or her Mahrams, she does not have to observe strict rules of covering. And she is able to uncover her hair, face, neck, arms, hands, legs from below the knee, and feet. A desired trait of a Muslim woman is Haya (shyness and modesty), therefore she must never make a wanton display of herself.

****Hijab****

The word Hijab means conceal, hide or screen. It is popularly known to be a woman's headscarf (a veil which usually covers the head and chest) but actually hijab is much more than that. It is a broader term meaning modest clothing and behavior. In terms of clothing it would mean using the proper dress to cover the Awrah.

** Women must cover their entire body except the face and hands for prayer (Salah) whether in public or private.

** For men it is recommended to cover from shoulder to below the knee while must cover Awrah at all times during prayer (salah) whether in public or private.

It is permissible for women (not for men) to use cosmetics for beautification as long as it meets the following four conditions.

*(1) This beautification should not be for non-Mahram men.

*(2) The materials used for cosmetic purposes should be of permissible (such as Henna, kohl, lipstick, blusher, nail polish, etc) substances and do not contain or made from impure (such as pig fat) substances.

*(3) The materials used for cosmetic purposes should not be harmful to her body.

*(4) The cosmetic effect on the body should be temporary. It is not permissible to use substances that change the creation of Allah, such as lip treatments, tattoos, etc.

** Cosmetics that form layers such as nail polish must be removed before ablution (Wudoo).

Plucking eyebrows for beautification is forbidden in Islam.

DETAILED DISCUSSION with EVIDENCES

**Clothing from an Islamic Perspective:

<http://newmuslimguide.com/en/your-dress-code/108#section-1>

**The General Rule Regarding Clothing:

<http://newmuslimguide.com/en/your-dress-code/108#section-2>

**Forbidden Types of Clothing:

<http://newmuslimguide.com/en/your-dress-code/108#section-3>

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\*\*\*VIDEO LINKS\*\*\*

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\*\*Fiqh Of Dressing:

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=dcNARDNbl6E>

\*\*The Sunnah Dress by Dr. Yasir Qadhi:

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=mJfFh7Bg2C0>

\*\*\*\*\* Article # 12

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\*\*\*RULES OF FOOD AND DRINK\*\*\*

\*\*In Islam every food and drink is permissible unless it is prohibited by Allah or His Messenger (pbuh).

\*\* As Muslims we believe the ultimate purpose of food consumption is to maintain a healthy body which will enable us to worship Allah.

### Brief description of general guidelines and some prohibitions:

\*\* A key point to remember is that we eat to live, and not live to eat.

\*\* Halal (permissible) food means food (or drink) that are allowed for us to consume.

\*\* Haram (Forbidden or prohibited) food means food (or drink) that are not allowed for us to consume.

\*\* Any food (or drink) that is harmful for health or life is haram.

\*\* All kind of grains, vegetables, beans, lentils and fruits are permissible, and nothing has been explicitly forbidden in Islam.

\*\* All kind of sea plants and fishes (seafood, that can only survive in water) are permissible.

\*\* Blood consumption is forbidden.

\*\* Meat from Chicken, duck, turkey, cow, goat, lamb, camel, certain kind of birds, etc. are permissible as long as they are slaughtered according to Islamic law. Meat of these dead animals (if they die before slaughtering) are prohibited.

\*\* Pigs, all meat eating wild animals (tigers, cats, dogs, etc), all predatory birds (eagles, falcons, etc.), all land insects (except locusts), snakes, mouse, etc. are forbidden for consumption.

## Alcohol and drugs are forbidden.

### Etiquette of Eating and Drinking:

\*\* Avoid of eating or drinking in gold, silver, gold-plated or silver plated dishes, glasses or utensils.

\*\* Wash hands before eating.

**\*\*Always remember and start with the name of Allah saying "Bismillah".**

**\*\* Eat with right hand or using right hand.**

**\*\* Avoid excessive eating. It is recommended to fill one third of stomach with food, one third with water and leave one third for air.**

**\*\*It is ok, to not like certain kind of food but we should not criticize any food.**

**\*\* Finish eating expressing thank and praise to Allah saying, "Al-hamdu lillaah" (All praise and thank is due to Allah).**

**## Do not waste food and do not be extravagant.**

**\*\*\*DETAILED DISCUSSION with EVIDENCES\*\*\***

**\*\*\*\*\***

**## Your Food and Drink:**

<http://newmuslimguide.com/en/your-food-and-drink/64#section-1>

**## Intoxicants and Alcoholic Beverages:**

<http://newmuslimguide.com/en/your-food-and-drink/64#section-2>

**## Drugs:**

<http://newmuslimguide.com/en/your-food-and-drink/64#section-3>

**## Seafood & Land Animals:**

<http://newmuslimguide.com/en/your-food-and-drink/65#section-1>

**## Types of Lawful Animals:**

<http://newmuslimguide.com/en/your-food-and-drink/65#section-2>

**## Islamic Slaughter:**

<http://newmuslimguide.com/en/your-food-and-drink/65#section-3>

## Types of Meat Served in Restaurants and Shops: <http://newmuslimguide.com/en/your-food-and-drink/65#section-4>

## Hunting according to Islamic Law:

<http://newmuslimguide.com/en/your-food-and-drink/66#section-1>

## The Etiquette of Eating and Drinking:

<http://newmuslimguide.com/en/your-food-and-drink/66#section-2>

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VIDEO LINKS

** Fiqh of Food - Halaal & Haraam Animals (part-1):

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KPuve4x5edI&index=10&list=PLCF881755FDA7E7DC>

** Fiqh of Food - Halaal & Haraam Animals (part-2):

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=wsCFnrVm6pY&list=PLCF881755FDA7E7DC&index=11>

** Fiqh of Food - Halaal & Haraam Animals (part-3):

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=_6COd26rsJ4&index=12&list=PLCF881755FDA7E7DC

** Fiqh of Food - Halaal & Haraam Sea Animals:

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Z7Cq7-pfgJs&index=13&list=PLCF881755FDA7E7DC>

** Fiqh of Food - Halaal & Haraam Birds:

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0pX6NxZGCKc&index=14&list=PLCF881755FDA7E7DC>

** Fiqh of Food - Halaal & Haraam Vermins:

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?>

v=UG2B5qCsUDc&index=15&list=PLCF881755FDA7E7DC

** why is consumption of alcohol prohibited in islam:
<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=vcqy76dPGZg>

** Etiquettes of eating, drinking, etc: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ZVgoiU6pyg4>

***** Article # 13

RULES OF FAMILY AND MARRIAGE

**Family is the central entity of Islamic society. A Muslim is always part of a family as a child, parent or grandparent. Living alone and single life is discouraged in Islam.

**Allah has created men and women as company for one another (as husband and wife) and to procreate (for those of us able to have children) and live in peace and tranquility according to the Guidance of Allah.

**Unlike other religions (like Christianity, Buddhism, Judaism etc.) which consider celibacy or monasticism as a great virtue, Islam considers marriage and family life as one of the greatest virtues.

**All forms of free mixing and relationship between a men and women outside of a marriage is prohibited.

**Marriage is only between a Muslim man and a Muslim woman. In certain circumstances marriage between a Muslim man and a woman from the people of the book (Jews, Christians) may be allowed but are strongly discouraged. A new Muslim woman who is already married to a non Muslim husband should contact a local scholar to discuss her particular situation.

****The husband and wife are complimentary partners of the family who are not identical but are equal in the sight of Allah and play their respective role in the family and society.**

****Within a family a man (in the role of a husband and father) is primarily responsible for (1) Leadership, (2) Financial/Economic security (provider of food, lodging and all basic necessities of life) (3) Guidance and education (4) Protection and safety.**

****Within a family a woman (in the role of a wife and mother) is primarily responsible for (1) Housekeeping and cooking (2) Nurture, care and comfort (3) Advice and education (4) Keep-up with family ties and Preserve the honor and dignity of the family.**

****Marriage is meant to last a lifetime (and beyond). There is no concept of temporary marriage in Islam.**

****Divorce (Talaq) is allowed but are very very strongly discouraged and disliked.**

**** Marriage and Divorce are valid only when those are performed according to Islamic law under the authority of local Muslim Imam (Scholar of the mosque) with proper documentation. New Muslims are strongly advised to be careful, and learn the requirements and responsibilities of marriage before making such a decision.**

****It is an obligation upon every Muslim to take care of their elderly parents (even if they are non-Muslims) and grandparents. While the financial obligation (food, lodging and basic necessities) is primarily upon the son but the rest of the responsibilities may be shared between son and daughter.**

*****DETAILED DISCUSSION with EVIDENCES*****

****The Position of the Family in Islam:**

<http://newmuslimguide.com/en/your-family/122#section-1>

****The Position of Women in Islam:**

<http://newmuslimguide.com/en/your-family/122#section-2>

****Women That Islam Enjoins Muslims to Look after:** <http://newmuslimguide.com/en/your-family/122#section-3>

****No Place for a Struggle between the Sexes:** <http://newmuslimguide.com/en/your-family/122#section-4>

****Categories of Women in Relation to a Man:** <http://newmuslimguide.com/en/your-family/129#section-1>

****Rules for the Relationship between a Man and Women he Is Allowed to Marry:**
<http://newmuslimguide.com/en/your-family/129#section-2>

****Marriage in Islam:**
<http://newmuslimguide.com/en/your-family/130#section-1>

****The Wife's Rights:**
<http://newmuslimguide.com/en/your-family/130#section-2>

****The Husband's Rights:**
<http://newmuslimguide.com/en/your-family/130#section-3>

****Divorce:**
<http://newmuslimguide.com/en/your-family/131>

****Parents' Rights and Children's Rights:**
<http://newmuslimguide.com/en/your-family/132>

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### \*\*\*VIDEO LINKS\*\*\*

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\*\*Making marriage work - Responsibilities of a Muslim couple - Yasir Qadhi:  
<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=zmkWL0IHaic>

\*\*The Family & Raising children - Tips for Muslim Parents - Yasir Qadhi:  
<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=z1EEwEeVdKc>

\*\*Basic Fiqh - Yasir Qadhi - Marriage and Divorce part 1:  
<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=NCKJcQXrBYw>

\*\*Basic Fiqh - Yasir Qadhi - Marriage and Divorce part 2:  
<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Mme0yklQrok>

## \*\*\*\*\* Article # 14

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### \*\*\*RULES OF EMPLOYMENT AND FINANCIAL TRANSACTION\*\*\*

\*\* Earning a Halal (permissible/lawful) living whether through business or employment is a requirement in Islam. Allah has commanded us to work to earn our living and encouraged us not to depend on others.

\*\*Islam laid down certain guidelines for business and employment for the creation of an economy based on fair play and justice. The guidelines takes into account people's (both seller and buyer) interest, protects professional and financial rights, and resolve conflicts.

### Brief description of general guidelines and some prohibitions:

\*\*All kind of employment and business is permissible (Halal) unless our Shariah prohibits it. So, it is important to know what kind of employment and business dealings are prohibited (Haram).

\*\* Employment or business that deals with prohibited (Haram) items (products or concepts), such as usury/interest (Riba), gambling, lottery, prostitution, pornography, Alcohol, pork, etc. are prohibited (Haram). So, for example selling, distributing or working in any shape or form that involves alcohol (such as a Bar or restaurant) is prohibited (Haram).

\*\* Employment that are prohibited (Haram) due to certain conditions of the employment. So, for example if the employment requires an employee to shave his beard or dress in impermissible clothing or do not allow to fast/pray, etc. then that employment becomes prohibited (Haram).

\*\* Conditions that make a business prohibited (Haram). That means in business, selling permissible product, with deceptive means or techniques or inadequate information about quantity and quality or selling uncertainty (hidden amount or items or price) are prohibited (Haram).

\*\* In any transaction (employment or business) it is prohibited to make an offer when someone is already negotiating a deal. For example, if someone is negotiating a price of a car with the dealer for \$2000 dollars, it is prohibited to interfere with an offer of \$2500. One must wait until that deal negotiating ends or if the person (the first customer) allows him to do so.

\*\* All forms of bribery (giving or taking) and corruption in workplace and business is prohibited in Islam.

\*\* Finally, Islam puts income and financial obligation upon the muslim man (as husband or father). It is not an obligation put upon woman.

\*\*\*DETAILED DISCUSSION with EVIDENCES\*\*\*

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\*\*Your Financial Transactions:

<http://newmuslimguide.com/en/your-financial-transactions/62>

\*\*Usury (Ribaa) & Ruling on Ribaa:

<http://newmuslimguide.com/en/your-financial-transactions/63#section-1>

**\*\*Detrimental Effects of Ribaa on the Individual and Society:** <http://newmuslimguide.com/en/your-financial-transactions/63#section-3>

**\*\*What is the ruling regarding a person who embraces Islam while he is a party to an usurious contract:**  
<http://newmuslimguide.com/en/your-financial-transactions/63#section-4>

**\*\*Deception through Ignorance and Uncertainty (Gharar):** <http://newmuslimguide.com/en/your-financial-transactions/268#section-1>

**\*\*Injustice and Wrongfully Taking Other People's Property:** <http://newmuslimguide.com/en/your-financial-transactions/268#section-2>

**\*\* Gambling:**  
<http://newmuslimguide.com/en/your-financial-transactions/268#section-3>

**\*\*Examples of Business Ethics which Islam Has Stressed:** <http://newmuslimguide.com/en/your-financial-transactions/271>

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*****VIDEO LINKS*****

******* Article # 15**

***** RULES OF MORAL CHARACTER*****

** Noble character and good manners are very important in Islam. Allah sent His Guidance and the Prophet (pbuh) to perfect moral character.

** All human beings are created with certain natural tendencies of understanding good and evil. Islam clearly identifies good and evil; what is acceptable and what is unacceptable; what is moral and what is immoral; and thus leaves no ambiguity for us humans to set new standards.

** A moral individual is always conscious of the Guidance of Allah. A Muslim is genuinely best in manners when he is around people and when he is not around people. He knows Allah is always watching him.

** A Muslim is always conscious of other people's feelings and rights.

** A Muslim promotes good and justice in the society and call others to it.

** A Muslim is always against evil and injustice and calls others to it. The best among us will confront evil and injustice or to the very least (the weakest among us) hate it from his heart.

** Good behaviors (such as smiling or good words to someone or removing something from the walkway, etc.) are not only desired by Allah but also are considered acts of charity (kind of worship) by Allah and will be rewarded as such in this life and in the life of hereafter.

** Examples of some good morals are honesty, integrity, tolerance, kind, forgiving, humility, generous, grateful, fair, just, punctual, polite, respectful, helpful, sincere and patient.

** Examples of some bad morals are lying, backbiting, slander, cheating, pride, arrogance, jealousy, deception, treachery, disrespectful, intolerant, unjust, orally and physically abusive to others.

DETAILED DISCUSSION with EVIDENCES

**The Position of Good Character in Islam:

<http://newmuslimguide.com/en/your-moral-character/121#section-1>

****Distinguishing Features of Noble Character in Islam:**

<http://newmuslimguide.com/en/your-moral-character/121#section-2>

****Some Aspects of the Prophet's Life and High Moral Standards:**

<http://newmuslimguide.com/en/your-moral-character/123>

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**\*\*\*VIDEO LINKS\*\*\***

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## **\*\*\*\*\* Article # 16**

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### **\*\*\*\*A LIST OF COMMON ISLAMIC PHRASES AND EXPRESSIONS\*\*\*\***

This is a list of Arabic words or Phrases used by all Muslims irrespective of their language. Meaning and appropriate usage is mentioned.

#### **(1) When You Meet a Muslim**

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(a) Greet with saying "As-Salaamu-alaikum" ( which means "peace be upon you").

Respond with saying "Wa-alaikumus-Salam" (and peace be with you).

(b) or say "As-Salaamu-alaikum wa Rahmatullah" (Peace and mercy of Allah be upon you)

Respond with "Wa-alaikumus-Salam wa Rahmatullah" (and Peace and mercy of Allah be upon you)

(c) or say "As-Salaamu-alaikum wa Rahmatullahi wa Barakatuhu" (..... and His blessings)

Respond with "Wa-alaikumus-Salam wa Rahmatullahi wa Barakatuhu " (..... and His blessings).

(2) When start any (with few exceptions) Halal speech or action, Say

\*\*\*\*\*

(a) Bismillah (in the name of Allah).

(b) or, "Bismillahir-Rahmaan- ir-Raheem" (...the Most Compassionate, Most Merciful)

(3) When you want to Thank and or show Gratitude to Allah, Say

\*\*\*\*\*

Alhamdulillah- (all thank and praise is for Allah). An acknowledgement of content for everything we have (or given) and whatever conditions we are kept in by Allah. This phrase is known as Tahmid.

(4) When Intend To Do Something, Say

\*\*\*\*\*

In Sha Allah (Allah willing or if Allah wills). A reminder and acknowledgment that nothing can happen except by the will of Allah.

(5) When you're surprised or amazed by beauty or good, Say

\*\*\*\*\*

SubhanAllah (Glory be to Allah). An acknowledgement that Allah is perfect, above anything in the creation, and everything that comes from Him is perfect. This phrase is known as Tasbih.

(6) When admiring or praising someone, Say

\*\*\*\*\*

MashaAllah (as Allah wills or what Allah wills). An acknowledgement that everything comes from Allah.

(7) When Thanking Someone

\*\*\*\*\*

(a) Say, "Jazak-Allahu Khair" (may Allah reward you with good).

Respond with ""Wa iy-yakum" (and to you) or "Wa Antum, fa-Jazak-Allahu Khair" (and you too.....)

(b) or Say, "Barak-Allah feek" (may Allah bless you).

Respond with "Wa iy-yakum" (and to you).

(8) When you think you saw or did something wrong ( sin, mistake), Say

\*\*\*\*\*

Astaghfirullah (I seek the forgiveness of Allah). Usually uttered in silence.

(9) When approve of what you hear, see, to praise a speaker or express excitement, Say

\*\*\*\*\*

Allahu Akbar (Allah is greater or Allah is the greatest). This phrase is known as Takbir.

(10) When scared or feeling unsafe from evil thoughts or places, Say

\*\*\*\*\*

(a) Audhu billah (I seek refuge in and with Allah).

(b) or, "Audhu billahi minash-Shaytanir-Rajeem" (.... from Shaitan, the outcast)

(11) When struck with calamity, or taken over by a situation beyond your control, Say

\*\*\*\*\*  
\*\*

La hawla wa la quwwata illa billah (There is no power nor strength except by Allah)

(12) When afflicted by a calamity, misfortune or upon hearing news of death, Say

\*\*\*\*\*  
\*\*

Inna lillahi wa inna ilayhi rajiun (Indeed we belong to Allah, and indeed to Him we will return)

(13) When you Sneeze, Say

\*\*\*\*\*

Alhamdulillah- (all thank and praise is for Allah).

(14) When someone Sneezes and says, "Alhamdulillah", Say

\*\*\*\*\*

Yarhamuka Allah (May Allah have mercy upon you)

(15) When you spend time, money or effort only for Allah's Pleasure, Say

\*\*\*\*\*

Fi Sabilillah ('In the way of Allah' or 'For the cause of Allah' or 'for the sake of Allah'). You may use this term to let someone know that you do not want any worldly benefit in return, but not to show-off your generosity.

(16) When you mention Prophet Muhammad's (saws) name or hear being mentioned, Say

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\*

Sallahu alayhi wa Sallam (May Allah's peace and blessing be upon him). Written abbreviation (SAWS, SAW, SAS or pbuh).

(17) When you mention any prophet's name or hear being mentioned, Say

\*\*\*\*\*

Alayhis Salam (May Allah's Peace be upon him). Written abbreviation (AS or pbuh)

(18) When parting with someone, Say

\*\*\*\*\*

Fi Amanallah (In the Protection of Allah). Allah Hafiz (Allah is the Protector) is also used.

(19) When you end an answer to a Religious Question, Say

\*\*\*\*\*

Allahu Alam (Allah knows the best).

(20) Following are optional but widely used phrases

\*\*\*\*\*



(a) RadiAllahu anhu (May Allah be pleased with him). Used after names of Companions of the Prophet (pbuh). Written abbreviation (RA).

(b) Rahimahullah (may Allah have mercy on him). Used after names of well known scholars of the past. Another variation "Rahmatullah Alaihi" of same meaning is also in use.

## \*\*\*\*\* Article # 17

\*\*\*\*\*

\*\*\*BIOGRAPHY (SIRAH) OF PROPHET MUHAMMAD (Pbuh)\*\*\*

\*\*Prophet Muhammad (pbuh), the Last and Final Messenger of Allah.

\*\* The Prophet (pbuh) lived his life according to Allah's Guidance (Quran- the Last and Final revelation) and set an example for us to follow until the Last-Day.

\*\* The Prophet (pbuh) was the perfect slave and worshipper of Allah. And in him we find the best and only example to follow.

\*\* All other earlier prophets (and messengers) were sent to certain people, their message and example they set were for a certain period of time. Prophet Muhammad (pbuh) was sent to everyone and until the Last-Day.

\*\*The coming of Prophet Muhammad (pbuh) with final revelation (Quran) invalidated all other earlier revelations. Even though we are to believe in the existence of those revelations, but in no way we are to follow those revelations or follow the examples and teachings found in those.

\*\* It is important to understand that we are required to believe in the earlier prophets (and messengers) and the revelations but we are required to follow only Prophet Muhammad (pbuh) and the Final revelation (Quran).

\*\*Therefore it is very important for all of us to know about the life of the Prophet (pbuh). How else will we follow his footsteps to draw close to Allah? Through his biography and his Sunnah ('his way' - recorded in Hadith collections) we get to know the greatest man ever lived and set an example for all of us to follow.

\*\*It is also very important to know the Sirah (biography) from authentic sources only, otherwise we will be learning of things he never did and thus will be misguided instead of guided.

### A brief outline of Prophet Muhammad's (pbuh) biography (Sirah):

\*\*\*\*\*

\*\* Prophet Ibrahim (Abraham) left his second wife Hagar and son Ismail (Ishmael) all alone in a barren desert by the order of Allah. Allah sprung up a water well (known as Zamzam) there, which enable them to survive and eventually others came there, which is known as city of Makkah today. Later on prophet Ibrahim visited them few times. Prophet Ibrahim and Ismail together built a house of worship there by the order of Allah, which is known as Kabah. Prophet Ismail and his progeny lived there since then.

\*\* Prophet Muhammad (pbuh) is a descendent of prophet Ibrahim through the line of prophet Ismail.

\*\* It is most popularly believed that he was born in 9th or 12th of Rabiul-Awwal (third month of Islamic calendar) in 570 or 571 CE, in the city of Makkah in the Arabian Peninsula, part of modern day Saudi Arabia.

\*\* His two most common names are Muhammad and Ahmad. He was named Muhammad by his grandfather.

\*\* His Father Abdullah bin Abdul-Muttalib died before his birth. His mother Aminah died when he was six years old.

\*\*He was under the care of his grandfather Abdul-Muttalib and after the death of his grandfather at age eight he was under the care of his paternal uncle Abu Talib.

\*\* In his early years he was a shepherd and later on he learned the art of trading. As a young man he was often hired by people to trade for them and was well known for his trading skills, honesty and integrity.

\*\* He was well known among the people of Makkah for his manners and was referred to as 'As-Sadiq' (The Truthful One) and 'Al-Amin' (The Trustworthy One).

\*\* He married Khadijah, upon a proposal from her when he was 25 years old. At that time Khadijah was a divorcee and widow (from her two previous marriages) and mother of three children and was 15 years older than him. They were together for 25 years until her death and had 6 children of whom 4 survived.

\*\* He was deeply concerned about the situations surrounding him in Makkah. Idol worship, drinking, gambling, unlimited spouses, infanticide due to poverty, ill treatment of women, killing of female child for false sense of honor and constant fighting between tribes were the norms in that society.

\*\* When he was forty years old, he received the first revelation (5 verses of the Quran) from Allah, which was brought to him by angel Jibril (Gabriel), in the month of Ramadhan around 610CE. His mission as Prophet and Messenger officially began at that moment. Revelation of Quran would continue for the next 23 years until his death.

\*\* The Makkans (people of Makkah) vehemently opposed his message of worship of Allah alone and his messengership.

\*\* For the first three years he was secretly calling people to Islam. His wife Khadijah was the very first person, Abu-Bakr was first man and Ali was the first adolescent to accept Islam. Muslim reverts (or converts) of this period were few and went through extreme torture, persecution and death.

\*\* For the next 10 years, he was calling people openly to Islam. Which enraged the Makkan polytheists and their torture and persecution intensified many folds. Numbers of reverts kept increasing in this period and message of Islam spread into surrounding cities.

\*\* Makkan Polytheists tried everything to destroy Islam and the Prophet (pbuh). They falsely accused him of being a liar, magician and a poet. They tried to lure him with wealth, women and position of leadership. They tried to compromise. Then came the boycott and physical assaults and threat of murder.

\*\* In the sixth year of his prophecy the conversion of Hamzah and Umar (two prominent Makkans) brought some relief and strength to the growing number of Muslim minority.

\*\* After the death of his uncle Abu Talib (a prominent leader) and his wife Khadijah on the tenth year of his prophecy, the polytheist Makkans started the preparation to Assassinate him and crush the growing movement.

\*\* During the next three years (from 11th to 13th) the miracle of 'Nocturnal journey to Jerusalem' and 'ascension to heaven and return' took place; and the order of 5 obligatory daily prayers were given by Allah. In this period some people from Madinah came to the Prophet and reverted to Islam.

\*\* Number of Muslims were growing in Madinah and in the thirteenth year of his prophecy a group of Muslims from Madinah came and invited him to come to Madinah. They (Muslims and non-Muslims) also offered him protection and leadership of Madinah.

\*\* Gradual revelation of Quran continued in this period. Whenever revelation came to the Prophet (pbuh) , he would memorize it, teach others and would have it written down by the scribes. Revelations during the first 13 years of his prophecy dealt with pure worship of Allah alone (Tawhid), fundamental beliefs (Aqidah), morality, and stories of the prophets and previous generations.

\*\* Finally, after 13 years of calling people to Islam in Makkah, Allah ordered the Prophet (pbuh) and the Muslims to migrate (known as Hijrah) to Madinah. Makkan polytheists plotted a huge plan to assassinate him. Allah informed the Prophet (pbuh) and he escaped in the darkness of night, foiling their final attempt on his life and moved to Madinah in 622/623CE.

\*\* In the first year after Hijrah (migration to Madinah) he began a new chapter of his mission in Madinah. The first thing he did in Madinah was to build a mosque (masjid) and open call for prayer (Adhan) was initiated.

\*\* As the leader of Madinah he was dealing with the Muslims, polytheists and the Jews. He immediately began to work on formulizing a constitution which came to be known as "Constitution of Madinah". In this period permission to resist and fight evil was granted by Allah.

\*\*In the first two years after the Hijrah number of Muslim converts continued to rise steadily. Qiblah (direction of prayer) was changed from Jerusalem to Makkah (to the direction of Kabah) and fasting in Ramadhan was made obligatory for Muslims by the order of Allah.

\*\*The steady rise of growing number and power of Muslims worried the Makkans. So, they launched an attack (known as Battle of Badr) on the Muslims two years after the Prophet (pbuh) migrated to Madinah. This was a major event in which the small (around 300 men) Muslim army defeated a powerful Makkan army (around 1000 armed soldiers) against all odds. This victory dealt a heavy blow to the polytheists of entire Arabia and earned recognition of the new Muslim state in Madinah.

\*\*In the third year after Hijrah, Allah made Zakat obligatory upon Muslims. The Makkan Polytheists would come back this year with a larger army (with the help of neighboring cities) of three thousand to crush the new Muslim state. Prophet (pbuh) was able to manage about thousand Muslims to confront them what is known as the battle of Uhud. There were casualty on both sides and neither side own a decisive victory. This gave a moral boost to the enemies of Islam both inside and outside of Madinah.

\*\* In the fifth year after Hijrah, Makkans would come back with a much bigger army of around ten thousand, aided by the help from surrounding cities in Arabia and the hypocrites and Jews of Madinah. This large force would surround Madinah from all sides. The Prophet (pbuh) only had around 3000 able Muslim men to fight and defend the city. Muslims dug trenches all around Madinah and fought a long hard battle from within, which is known as "Battle of Khandaq" (or Battle of Confederates). After a long hard battle Muslims won decisively when the enemies left. This battle proved the Muslims were ready to confront any enemy no matter how huge they were and cemented the power of the new Muslim state in Madinah.

\*\* In the sixth after Hijrah, Prophet (pbuh) and his companions left for Makkah intending to perform Umrah (the lesser Pilgrimage). But they were intercepted (against the prevailing norms of Arabia) before reaching Makkah and were forced to turn back with a treaty known as "treaty of Hudaibiyah".

\*\* The "treaty of Hudaibiyah" seemed one sided and favoring the Polytheists of Makkah. But the Prophet (pbuh) was content with it as it at least guaranteed peace for next ten years. The Prophet (pbuh) had time finally to focus on the new state and the spread of Islam beyond the boundaries of Arabia. This helped Islam spread faster and large number of non-Muslims were converting to Islam.

\*\* Late in the sixth year after Hijrah, the Prophet (pbuh) sent messages to the kings in Arabia and beyond such as king of Ethiopia, Egypt, Persia, Rome, etc., calling them to Islam.

\*\*In the eighth year after Hijrah, Prophet (pbuh) was able to conquer Makkah without bloodshed. And instead of revenge he declared general amnesty. He immediately removed all idols and images from the Kabah, purified it and restored Makkah's sanctity and announced that it was not to be violated thereafter. The Muslims were finally in control of all affairs (religious and political) in Arabia.

\*\*In the ninth year after Hijrah, Allah made Hajj obligatory for Muslims. Prophet (pbuh) sent a group of several hundred Muslims lead by Abu-bakr to perform Hajj that year for the first time. During this Hajj Allah revealed verses prohibiting all non-Islamic and pre-Islamic practices in and around Kabah and in Makkah.

\*\*In the tenth year after Hijrah, the Prophet (pbuh) performed Hajj with a great numbers of Muslims along with him. There he delivered a sermon explaining many important principles of Islam. This is known as "Farewell Pilgrimage" as this was his only and last Hajj.

\*\* In the eleventh year after Hijrah, the prophet (pbuh) fell ill, and was sick for about ten days and died on 12th of Rabiul-Awwal at the age of 63.

\*\* Last verses of the Quran were revealed few days before his death. Revelations during the last 10 years of his prophecy dealt mostly with laws of governing Islamic state and its subjects in every aspect of life, and also dealt with perfection of some ritual worship.

\*\*At his death he left behind the Quran and his Sunnah (recorded in Hadith collections) and a group of companions (known as Sahabah, most of whom were converts), who took the message of Islam far beyond the boundaries of Arabia to Asia, Africa and Europe within the next 100 years.

\*\*\*BEST SOURCES ON PROPHET'S (PBUH) BIOGRAPHY (SIRAH)\*\*\*

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#### BOOKS:

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(1) The Sealed Nectar by Safi-ur-Rahman al-Mubarkpuri ( ISBN #9781591440703). This biography is less detailed and based on authentic sources. Online:

[https://www.muslim-library.com/dl/books/English\\_ArRaheeq\\_AlMakhtum\\_THE\\_SEALED\\_NECTAR.pdf](https://www.muslim-library.com/dl/books/English_ArRaheeq_AlMakhtum_THE_SEALED_NECTAR.pdf)

(2) Prophet of Islam by Dr. Mahdi Rizqullah Ahmad ( ISBN #9789960969039). This biography detailed, most authentic with extensive references.

(3) Noble life of the Prophet by Dr. Ali Muhammad Sallabi (ISBN #9789960967868), is a more detailed biography. Online: <https://www.kalamullah.com/muhammad.html>

ONLINE:

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(1) THE SEALED NECTAR:

\*\* [http://muslimconverts.com/Prophets\\_of\\_Allah/index.htm](http://muslimconverts.com/Prophets_of_Allah/index.htm)

\*\* <https://islamgreatreligion.wordpress.com/welcome-to-islam-worlds-greatest-religion/ar-raheeq-al-makhtum-the-sealed-nectar/>

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VIDEO LINKS

(1) Seerah of Prophet Muhammed by Yasir Qadhi: This is the 1st of 104 part video Series;

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=VOUp3ZZ9t3A&list=PLAEA99D24CA2F9A8F>

(2) Life of Muhammad (pbuh) by Mufti Menk: This is 1st of 30part video series:

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=VO22I6-Qkys&list=PLEe4sh5Y1RVOHOZHprY6uCKcTeoYF_Gge

***** Article # 18

WHAT IS WITHIN ISLAM AND OUTSIDE OF (SECTS, CULTS) OF ISLAM

Suppose you are one of those individuals who searched and found Islam and became Muslim and it happened that you encountered individuals, books or websites that call themselves Muslims, but there are certain beliefs and practices that seem unusual. Or, you may have been introduced to Islam by someone or a source that seem to be at odds with the majority of the Muslims. Or, You simply came across few groups and not sure who to follow.

KEEP IN MIND THE FOLLOWING THREE POINTS: (1) Islam is a complete religion and division in Islam is forbidden. (2) What is within Islam? Legitimate differences of opinions which are allowed and not considered as division. (3) What is outside of Islam? The deviant sects and cults are not part of Islam.

ISLAM IS A COMPLETE RELIGION & DIVISION IN ISLAM IS FORBIDDEN

*

The very first thing you should understand is that Islam is complete and Allah commands Unity . Allah directly (in Quran) and indirectly (through Prophet Muhammad-saws) forbade and warned us against division. Allah said many places in Quran:

* (i) "This day I have perfected for you your religion and completed My favor upon you and have approved for you Islam as religion." (Quran 5:3)

* (ii) And hold fast, all of you together, to the Rope of Allah (i.e. this Quran), and be not divided among yourselves.." (Quran 3:103)

* (iii) Indeed, those who have divided their religion and become sects - you (Muhammad) are not [associated] with them in anything. (Quran 6:159)

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## WHAT IS WITHIN ISLAM:

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Following Allah's Order and Guidance is considered within Islam. These information is found in Quran and in authentic Hadith collections.

The Prophet (saws) lived according to Allah's Guidance and set an example for us to follow. The way he lived, called Sunnah (that is his saying, actions, approvals, disapprovals, etc.) is recorded in authentic Hadith collections. Let us know the following terms before further discussions.

\* 'Shariah' means total collection of the Islamic laws which are found in Quran and Hadith.

\* 'Fiqh' is a collection of laws deduced from Quran and Hadith to cover specific situations not directly covered in Shariah.

\* 'Ijtihad' is the process of finding solutions to new circumstances through interpretation of Quran and Hadith. 'Mujtahid' is a scholar involved in Ijtihad. When there is an agreement of all the mujtahids on a solution (a decision reached through Ijtihad) we call it 'Ijmaa' (scholarly consensus).



\* 'Qiyas' (deriving rules through analogy from Quran and Hadith) a specific variant of the general concept of Ijtihad.

### During the Prophet's lifetime, the only source of Islamic law was divine revelation either direct (which is found in Quran) or indirect through the Prophet (which is found in Hadith). The Prophet (saws) also taught his companions (Sahabah) how to find solutions to problems (through Ijtihad) using Quran and his Sunnah.

### After the death (around 632 CE) of the Prophet (saws), new situations arose (which were not directly dealt in Quran or Hadith) as Islam was spreading to outside of Arabia during the time of the four Righteous Caliphs and the major Sahabahs. In that era (the first 30 years after the prophet's death) they used Ijtihad and Ijmaa extensively to derive solutions to new problems and thus set example for the later generations to follow.

In that era, the combined approval of the Righteous Caliphs and the Sahabahs in the matter of legal rulings promoted unity and provided little or no opportunity for factionalism among the Muslims. As far as Fiqh was concerned, only one Madhhab (school of Islamic legal thought) existed during the period of the Righteous Caliphs. Although some Sahabah debated and differed on some points and certain interpretations, their differences rarely reached the level of disunity and factionalism.

### Thirty years after Prophet's (saws) death, as Islam spread far beyond the borders of Arabia and masses of people from all sorts of background (language, culture, religion) were entering into Islam, more and more new situations came for Islamic interpretation with fewer scholarly sahabahs available (in faraway lands) for interpretation and judgment.

\* By then, most major Muslim Provinces (countries as we call now) had Copies of the Quran and had few scholarly sahabahs (as most of the scholarly Sahabah stayed in Arabia). During that time Sunnah of the Prophet was not written and gathered in volumes as he have today in the Hadith collections. The scholarly sahabahs memorized many narrations from the Prophet (saws), and some had personal written materials ( a practice they started during the later part of the Prophet's life).

\* But not every scholarly sahabah knew every Sunnah or interpretation of every verse of the Quran from the Prophet. So, at times on new situations and problems sahabahs (who lived in faraway provinces) acted and made judgment based on what they knew and their training from the Prophet (saws).

\* They were always careful to relate that the opinion and judgment was their own (based on Quran and Sunnah) and they were not free from error as they pointed out the saying of the Prophet, "If a judge gives a verdict according to the best of his knowledge (Ijtihad) and his verdict is correct (i.e. agrees with Allah and His Prophet's verdict) he will receive a double reward, and if he gives a verdict according to the best of his knowledge and his verdict is wrong, even then he will get a single reward ." (Bukhari 7352).

\* And as we will find out later, that these judgments made in different parts of the Muslim world were not always identical.

\*\*So, we can see the early beginning of slightly different Fiqh ruling (on new issues) in different parts of the Muslim world. And their students (Tabi'een) on those areas learned and taught the next generation of students (Taba-at-Tabi'een).

### About one Hundred years after Prophet's (saws) death, we see the beginning of a formal school of Islamic legal thought (known as Madhhab) in Iraq. Later on, this school would be known as "Hanafi Madhhab" by the name of its most knowledgeable scholar and jurist Imam Abu Hanifa (699-767 CE).

\*\* Around the same time in Madinah we see another well known scholar Imam Malik (711-795 CE) becoming famous for his Jurisprudence and his school would come to be known as "Maliki Madhhab".

\*\* Few years later we would see another well known scholar and jurist from Makkah by the name Imam Ash-Shafee (767-820 CE) and his school would come to be known as "Shafee Madhhab".

\*\* And few years later, we see the last of the four major schools "Hanbali Madhhab" named after the famous scholar and jurist Imam Ahmad ibn Hanbal (780-855 CE).

\*\*All these four famous scholars and jurists were from the generation of Tabi'een or Taba-at-Tabi'een, of whom the Prophet (saws) said, "The best people are those of my generation, and then those who will come after them (i.e. the Tabi'een), and then those who will come after them (i.e. the Taba-at-Tabi'een)..." (Bukhari 6429).

Due to the circumstances mentioned above not all their legal decisions on certain new issues and problems were identical. This is why we see slightly different rulings and practices among the Muslims today.

\*\*\*The four Madhhabs were founded in different parts of the Muslim world before all major Hadith compilations were made.

### Within 250 years of Prophet's (saws) death, we had one of earliest extensive collection of Hadith (Musnad Ahmad by Imam Ahmed ibn Hanbal) and the two most authentic collections of Hadith (Bukhari and Muslim).

\* After the death of the Prophet (saws) the leading Sahabah realized the pressing need of preserving all his sayings and actions as he was no longer there for consultation. The scholarly sahabahs wrote down and taught others (Tabi'een) what they knew and learned from the Prophet.

\* With the spread of Islam narration of hadiths became widespread. Some people (though few in numbers) would narrate hadith with faulty memory, without proper reference (chain of narration), their personal opinion or some even fabricated Hadith.

\* To combat this situation we see during the era of the Tabi'een, scholars specializing and devoting their life in compilation of hadiths. We also see scholars focusing on Hadith instead of the existing traditional rulings of the earlier scholars to resolve the problems of Fiqh.

\* Great scholars of Hadith like Imam Bukhari (810-870 CE) and Imam Muslim (817-875 CE) dedicated their life to carefully collect authentic Hadith of the Prophet (saws) from all possible sources. This process lead us to have all major Hadith compilations (mainly the famous six Hadith collections) within 270 years after Prophet's (saws) death.

### From 250 years after Prophet's death till modern time. As time went on (with the invention of paper and printing) the entire collections of Hadith were becoming more easily available to the scholars of all parts of the world. Some early scholars noticed gaps and discrepancies in Hadith collections other than Bukhari and Muslim. Some of them dedicated their lives to authenticate the vast number of hadiths available in different collections.

Some later scholars (and their followers) of many schools (Madhhabs) changed their positions on existing early rulings based on proof from the available authentic Hadith collections. While others simply chose to continue to follow the existing rulings of the past.

#### ### IMPORTANT POINTS TO KEEP IN MIND:

- (1) Muslims consider legitimate differences in opinion between the four Madhhabs (schools of Islamic legal thought) within the boundaries of Islam and not as division.
- (2) The differences among the Madhhabs are few and trivial in nature. These differences do not affect any fundamental beliefs, pillars and major practices of Islam.
- (3) Primarily due to Political reasons and preference of early ruling dynasties (for example, Ottoman empires codified their Islamic laws according to Hanafi Madhhab) we see certain parts of Muslim world following rulings of a certain Madhhab.
- (4) One is free to follow a scholar of a particular Madhhab. For a person with little or no knowledge of Islam (layman), he is not allowed to derive rules from Quran and Hadith. An individual must learn (directly or indirectly) from knowledgeable, trustworthy and pious scholar (or sources). Scholars with the above qualities usually give references from Quran and Hadith for their particular opinion. Selectively choosing rules (for personal gain without valid reason) from different Madhhabs is also considered inappropriate.
- (5) Finally, a person may follow Hanafi Madhhab (or any other Madhhab) but if he finds a particular opinion of a scholar to be stronger (in terms of references from Quran and Hadith) than that of the Hanafi Madhhab, and follows that opinion than that is more appropriate.

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WHAT IS OUTSIDE OF ISLAM: (DEVIANT SECTS AND CULTS)

The sects and cults frequently use the term Islam or Muslim causing confusions among the new Muslims (converts). The sects may have some similarities and harder to identify. The Cults have major differences and easier to identify.

Our goal is not to offend anyone but to understand what we as Muslims consider unacceptable according to the Guidance of Allah.

It is totally unacceptable in Islam to offend any individual for their beliefs and practices. Our job is to sincerely advise them of the real truth and convey the true message of Allah.

Following is list of qualities of deviant sects and cults;

- * (i) Disregard for proofs and evidences from Quran and authentic Hadith collections.
- * (ii) Only accepting Quran and rejecting the Hadith (Sunnah of the Prophet Muhammad-saws) claiming those were not preserved or trustworthy.
- * (iii) Rejecting and disrespecting the four righteous Caliphs and the rest of the Sahabah (companions) of the Prophet Muhammad (saws).
- * (iv) Disregarding and disrespecting the mothers of the believers (the wives of the Prophet-saws).
- * (v) Accepting a living person (a leader, Imam, scholar, etc.) or a dead person (by visiting the grave) as mediator between Allah and themselves, and asking for help and intercession.
- * (vi) Accepting a person dead or alive after Prophet Muhammad (saws) as a Prophet (or Messenger) or giving similar status (of love, respect and obedience) using other terms.
- * (vii) Accepting new sources of religious law (other than Quran and Hadith) whether by direct revelation, dream or own intellect of a person (usually the cult founder).
- * (viii) Blindly following a person (usually the sect or cult leader or founder) and his teachings without verification from Quran and authentic Hadith.

SECTS: In general sects originate out of Islam and eventually deviate so much away from the true teachings of Islam that it is hard to believe they are within the fold of Islam. Example: Shia.

** SHIA (Shiaism): The followers are known as Shias or Shiites. Today they are about one tenth (7 to 10%) of the total Muslim population and primarily concentrated in Iran.

* This group (with few individuals) started with a political dispute over who is to succeed as the leader (the head of state) of the Muslims after the death of Prophet Muhammad (saws). They rejected the first three righteous Caliphs (head of state or leader of the Muslims) and regarded Ali, the fourth Caliph, as Prophet Muhammad's (saws) first true successor.

* In the early stages, what started as a movement known "Shiat Ali" or the "Party of Ali" would eventually reject almost all the Sahabahs (Companions of the Prophet-saws) and some of the wives of the Prophet (saws); and utter lies and curse towards them. In the process (after the death of Ali, Hasan and Hussain) they would go on to add beliefs and practices that have nothing to do with Islam or the teachings of the Prophet Muhammad (saws).

* In their rejection of almost all the Sahabah (thus almost all the authentic teachings of the Prophet-saws) they would deviate so far away from Islam that their version of Islam is no longer resembled what the Prophet Muhammad (saws) preached and established by the order of Allah.

* This group established something called the Imamate (political and spiritual leadership) of 12 Imams starting with Ali, Hasan, Hussain and nine more from Hussain's lineage. They believe the twelfth (also the Mahdi) Imam, Muhammad ibn al-Hasan al-'Askari (born around 969 CE), is still alive and living in the Tunnel of Samarra (in Iran) hidden from rest of us. He appears only to those who are most in need and to those who are most virtuous and pious.

* They exaggerate about their Imams, giving them status and qualities equal (or more in some qualities compared to all other prophets except prophet Muhammad-saws) to the prophets, claiming that they are appointed by God, infallible, sinless, perfect in highest sense of the word, have knowledge of the unseen, etc. They believe Imams have direct knowledge from God, and their verdict is the verdict of God. They devote many acts of worship to or through (mediator) them such as supplication, seeking help, offering sacrifices and tawaf (circumambulating their tombs), etc.

* They claim that many of the verses of the Quran's meaning is only known to the Imams and only they can interpret the Quran. They also have their own version of Hadith most of which are fabricated or attributed to their Imams.

They believe in Taqiya (or Taqiya meaning conceal or hide), which means they are allowed to hide or lie about their religion or belief (or practices) when they feel necessary, usually to save life or perceiving injustice, unequal treatment or to save honor and property.

* Their mourning ceremonies such as Ashura, in which they flagellate themselves to commemorate Hussein's death at Karbala, has nothing to do with Islam.

* In terms of practices their Sahadah, Adhan, prayer, etc., has major or minor differences from the mainstream Muslims. They also permit Muttah (fixed-term temporary marriage) which is forbidden in Islam.

CULTS: Cults may or may not originate out of Islam but are clearly outside Islam even though they may use the word Islam, Muslim, Quran or certain practices of Islam. Some examples of cults are listed below.

** Ahmadiyya (Qadiyani, Qadiani or Ahmadi): This cult is officially known as Ahmadiyya Muslim Community (or Ahmadiyya Muslim Jama'at). This cult is founded in 1889 by Mirza Ghulam Ahmad (1835-1908) of Qadian, Punjab, India. He claimed himself to be the long awaited Messiah of the old testament,

a new Prophet and the second coming of Jesus. This cult is very difficult to detect for a new Muslim as they identify themselves as Muslims and Islam as their religion, and hold to many of the outwardly practices of Islam.

** Ismaili (Aga Khani or Nizari): The Shia Imami Ismaili Muslims, generally known as the Ismailis, is a cult split out of Shia on disagreement over their choice of the seventh Imam. The dominant Ismaili branch believe in the line of Imamatus in hereditary succession continuing from Ali to seventh Imam Ismail to His Highness the Aga Khan, who is their present, 49th Imam. This cult is easier to identify as its beliefs and practices are very different from Islam.

** Nation of Islam: The Nation of Islam was founded by Wallace Muhammad in Detroit in 1930. This cult has nothing to do with Islam except that it uses the word Islam on its name.

*Miscellaneous Topic: one

*Miscellaneous Topic: 2

*Miscellaneous Topic: 3

*Miscellaneous Topic: 4

*Miscellaneous Topic: 5